

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: It's time to have a conversation!



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you socialize with classmates or co-workers?
- Where do you usually go to socialize?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social activities.
- I can link sounds in spoken English.
- I can change topics in a conversation.





Let's Explore!

Ferdinand tells Renata about his **stomping ground***!

* A "stomping ground" refers to a place where someone likes to go or often visits.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Ferdinand:** Hello Renata. You look tanned!
- Renata:** Thanks Ferdinand! I soaked up the sun in Cuba.
- Ferdinand:** Speaking of beaches and Cuba, how about grabbing a drink?
- Renata:** Tempting. But I have to return to the office after lunch.
- Ferdinand:** Now that you mention work, why don't we go to the art crawl after work?
- Renata:** Sounds good to me. Oh, that reminds me that Flamingo is hosting a French DJ this weekend. I go clubbing there all the time. I find dancing is a great way to let your hair down. It has a great dance floor. Where do you go?
- Ferdinand:** L'humeur is my usual stomping ground, but it has a lousy dance floor. I want to DJ. Maybe I'll take some classes. But going back to what you were saying, I'll have to join you at the Flamingo some time. On a change of note, I was wondering, how do you find the change working in our office?
- Renata:** More relaxing. Interestingly, I worked hard with Greta, but I didn't actually produce more.
- Ferdinand:** Why's that? Greta's very talented. I know this has nothing to do with our conversation, but I was reading an article on rock climbing. Would you be interested in joining me?
- Renata:** Funny you should say that! Did I ever tell you about my disastrous tree climbing adventure?
- Ferdinand:** As a matter of fact, you haven't! You can tell me on the way to the art crawl.
- Renata:** Great! See you later.





Let's Practice!

It's time to link sounds!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Circle the words where you link a sound. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. in / up / sun / Cuba / . / I / soaked / the

2. about / of / Cuba, / how / why / ? / grabbing / the / a / drink / and / or / beaches / we / go / Speaking / don't / art / work / to / after / crawl

3. Flamingo / reminds / is / that / hosting / a / French / your / me / weekend / . / this / find / DJ / that / dancing / a / I / way / to / let / hair / down / . / is / great

4. reading / conversation / in / know / has / to / do / I / with / , / but / I / joining / was / our / an / on / climbing / . / Would / this / article / you / interested / me / ? / nothing / rock / be

5. ever / Did / you / I / tell / about / my / Hey / disastrous / climbing / tree / ? / ! / adventure





Let's Practice!

It's time to change the topic!

Instructions: Read the expression to change topic in a conversation. Use the expressions below to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- Speaking of
- Did I ever tell you about
- On a change of note
- I know this has nothing to do with our conversation, but
- Now that you mention work
- Funny you should say that
- that reminds me that
- Interestingly

Ferdinand: Hello Renata. You look tanned!

Renata: Thanks Ferdinand! I soaked up the sun in Cuba.

Ferdinand: _____ beaches and Cuba, how about grabbing a drink?

Renata: _____ Tempting. But I have to return to the office after lunch.

Ferdinand: _____ why don't we go to the art crawl after work?

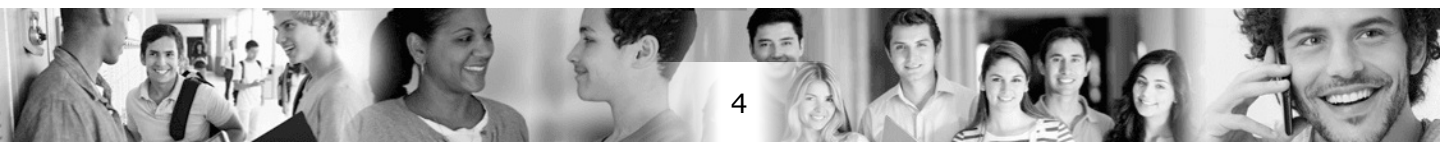
Renata: Sounds good to me. Oh, _____ Flamingo is hosting a French DJ this weekend.

Ferdinand: I'll have to join you at the Flamingo some time. _____, I was wondering, how do you find the change working in our office?

Renata: More relaxing. _____, I worked hard with Greta, but I didn't actually produce more.

Ferdinand: Why's that? Greta's very talented. _____ I was reading an article on rock climbing. Would you be interested in joining me?

Renata: _____ ! _____ my disastrous tree climbing adventure?





Extension Activity

Let's change the topic. Role-play a situation with your partner.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read the situation.
- Practice talking about the situation. Continue speaking for as long as you can.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I talk about social activities.

☐ ☐

I change the topic in a conversation.

☐ ☐

I link sounds while speaking.

☐ ☐

Situation: You are talking to a group of co-workers. You are talking about your weekends. You want to change the topic of the conversation. Use expressions to successfully change the topic at least 3 times.



Target Words

- **to soak up the sun** (verb): to sit outside for a long time enjoying the sun
e.g. I soaked up the sun in Cuba.
- **to grab a drink** (verb): to go out and get drinks
e.g. How about grabbing a drink after work?
- **to DJ** (verb): to play, cut and mix recorded music
e.g. I've always wanted to try DJing.
- **go clubbing** (expression): the activity of going to nightclubs
e.g. I go clubbing there all the time!
- **art crawl** (noun): to travel to one location from another looking at artwork
e.g. Why don't we go to the art crawl after work?
- **to let your hair down** (expression): to relax and do what you want
e.g. Dancing is a great way to let your hair down.



Learning Points

Changing Topics in a Conversation

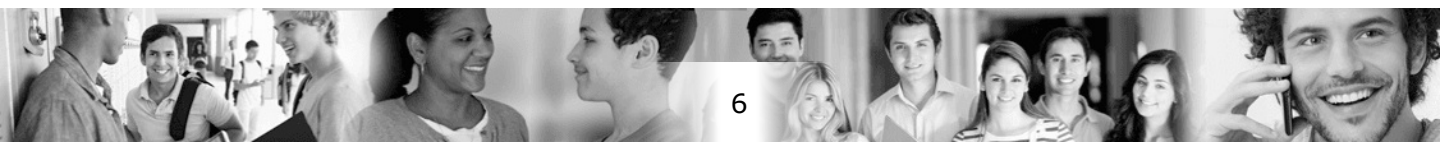
When speaking a foreign language, especially English, it is important that you acquire a set of conversation strategies which will help you deal with the spontaneity of spoken English. A very important strategy you need to master is changing topics in a conversation. Here are a few expressions you can use to change the subject of a conversation.

Changing the subject

- *Speaking of ...*
- *Now that you mention + noun ...*
- *Oh, that reminds me (that) ...*
- *On a change of note ...*
- *Interestingly ...*
- *I know this has nothing to do with our conversation, but ...*
- *Funny you should say that! Did I ever tell you about + noun ... ?*

Examples:

- ***Speaking of*** food, would you like to grab a bite to eat soon?
- ***Funny you should say that! Did I ever tell you about*** my terrible experience when traveling to Amsterdam?
- ***On a change of note***, I was wondering, how do you find the change working in our office?
- ***Interestingly***, I worked hard with Greta, but I didn't actually produce more.





Learning Points

Connected Speech: Linking Sounds in Spoken English

In spoken English, sometimes you may have problems understanding what people are saying. This is not because you don't know the words being said, or because the person was speaking too fast, but because the words have been connected and the sounds changed.

In English, there are two types of linking.

1. Consonant to Vowel: when there is a consonant at the end of a word and a vowel at the beginning of the following word, they are linked.

- *Hey, how about grabbing a drink?*
- *I soaked up the sun in Italy.*

1. Consonant to Consonant: when the final consonant of a word is the **same** as the first consonant of the following word, the consonant is pronounced as one long sound. There is no pause between the sounds.

- *I'll join you at the Flamingo. [sounds like → I'll join you a The Flamingo.]*
- *As a matter of fact, you haven't. [sounds like → As a matter o Fact ...]*

